THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Mid-Term / Half-Yearly Examination · Session 2026–27 · Set 02

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 02	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The ancient Indian science of plant and tree care, formalised in the 10th century CE in a text by Surapala, is called — **(1)**

(A) Dhanurveda (B) Vrikshayurveda
(C) Arthashastra (D) Sushruta Samhita

(ii) In which year did Sikkim become India's first 100 per cent organic state? **(1)**

(A) 2006 (B) 2011 (C) 2016 (D) 2021

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Formation of the Khalsa by Guru Gobind Singh
2. First Battle of Panipat
3. Battle of Saraighat
4. Second Battle of Panipat

(A) 4, 2, 3, 1 (B) 2, 3, 4, 1 (C) 2, 4, 1, 3 (D) 2, 4, 3, 1

(iv) Which Delhi ruler called himself 'Sikander Sani' (the second Alexander) on his coins? **(1)**

(A) Muhammad bin Tughlaq (B) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(C) Ala-ud-din Khilji (D) Sher Shah Suri

(v) The Ahom kingdom of Assam raised labour and soldiers through a system in which every able-bodied man served the state. It was called the — **(1)**

(A) Paik system (B) Iqta system
(C) Jagir system (D) Mansabdari system

(vi) Where was Chhatrapati Shivaji crowned with full Vedic rites in 1674? **(1)**

(A) Pune (B) Pratapgad (C) Sindhudurg (D) Raigad

(vii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: Tarabai, the widow of Rajaram, was the architect of the northward Maratha expansion.

Statement II: Peshwa Bajirao I and Nanasaheb Peshwa drove the Maratha expansion only up to the Deccan and never beyond it.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct

(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(viii) The Battle of Colachel (1741), in which a Dutch force was decisively defeated, was fought against the kingdom of — **(1)**

(A) Mysore (B) Travancore (C) Hyderabad (D) Bengal

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): The Great Rebellion of 1857 failed to end British rule.

Reason (R): The rebels lacked a unified command and a consistent strategy.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect

(B) A is incorrect, R is correct

(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A

(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(x) Identify the correct match. **(1)**

(A) Santhal Rebellion – 1831–32 (B) Santhal Rebellion – 1855–56

(C) Santhal Rebellion – 1859–62 (D) Santhal Rebellion – 1806

(xi) How many seats in the Lok Sabha are reserved for Scheduled Castes? **(1)**

(A) 47 (B) 131 (C) 412 (D) 84

(xii) What fraction of the members of the Rajya Sabha retire every two years? **(1)**

(A) One-third (B) One-half (C) One-fourth (D) One-fifth

(xiii) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: Parliament of India meets in three sessions every year — Budget, Monsoon and Winter.

Statement II: Money Bills can be introduced only in the Rajya Sabha.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct

(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(xiv) From 2014, Indian law requires eligible companies to spend a share of their average profits on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR). What share was fixed? **(1)**

(A) 1 per cent (B) 5 per cent (C) 2 per cent (D) 10 per cent

(xv) Which of the following goods is produced by a capital-intensive process? **(1)**

(A) Handloom cloth (B) Wheat from a small farm

(C) Handmade pottery (D) Semiconductor chips

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Give any two reasons for the political instability of the Delhi Sultanate. **(2)**

O R

2.(B) What was Muhammad bin Tughlaq's token currency? Why did it fail? **(2)**

3. Differentiate between ecosystem functions and ecosystem services. **(2)**

4.(A) What is NOTA? State its use. **(2)**

O R

4.(B) What is the Model Code of Conduct? State one rule in it. **(2)**

5. State any two ways in which the Judiciary checks the Legislature and the Executive. **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three features of the Ahom kingdom. **(3)**

O R

6.(B) Explain any three features of the Rajput resistance led by Maharana Pratap. **(3)**

7.(A) Describe any three features of the Maratha navy. **(3)**

O R

7.(B) Explain any three features of the Maratha judicial system. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the policy of Akbar towards Rajputs and people of other faiths. Mention any five points. **(5)**

O R

8.(B) Explain the effects of the policies of Aurangzeb on the Mughal Empire. Mention any five points. **(5)**

9. 'Colonial rule led to the dismantling of India's traditional systems.' Support the statement with the help of five points. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Cement is essential for houses, schools, bridges and airports, but its production is among the most polluting industries. Its fine dust damages the lungs of humans and animals, settles on leaves and lowers crop yields, and pollutes soil and water. The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) has therefore issued guidelines for cement factories. Builders are also turning to old and new alternatives — stone, mud, plant-based materials and bricks made from recycled waste plastic.

Questions:

(10.1) Which body has issued pollution-control guidelines for cement factories? (1)

(10.2) How does cement dust harm crops? (1)

(10.3) Suggest two ways of reducing the harm caused by cement production and use. (2)

11. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Guru Tegh Bahadur, the ninth Sikh Guru, was approached in 1675 by Kashmiri Pandits who were being persecuted. He stood by them. Emperor Aurangzeb ordered him to give up his faith, and when he refused, he was publicly beheaded in Chandni Chowk, Delhi. His son, Guru Gobind Singh, the tenth and last Guru, established the Khalsa in 1699 as a martial brotherhood committed to justice, equality and defence of the faith.

Questions:

(11.1) Who was the ninth Sikh Guru mentioned in the passage? (1)

(11.2) In which year was the Khalsa established? (1)

(11.3) Why did Guru Tegh Bahadur accept martyrdom? (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In India, elected members are the voters' own representatives. The President is elected by an Electoral College made up of the elected Members of Parliament and the elected Members of the state Legislative Assemblies, including those of Delhi and Puducherry. The vote is by the single transferable vote. The nominated members of the Rajya Sabha and of the state assemblies, and the members of Legislative Councils, do not take part.

Questions:

(12.1) Which two bodies' elected members form the Electoral College for electing the President? (1)

(12.2) Name one group that does not vote in the Presidential election. (1)

(12.3) Why are nominated members kept out of the Presidential election? (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Ratna wants to start a small restaurant. She rents a shop (land) and buys ovens and tables (capital). She hires cooks and waiters (labour), and she herself decides the menu and takes the risk of the venture (entrepreneurship). She uses a mobile app to take orders and accept UPI payments. Within a year, her restaurant is known for its trained staff and consistent quality.

Questions:

(13.1) Which factor of production does Ratna herself represent? (1)

(13.2) Name the technology mentioned in the passage that helps her business. (1)

(13.3) How can Ratna improve the human capital of her staff? Give two ways. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: **(5)** (5×1=5)

(I) Fatehpur Sikri
(II) Chittorgarh
(III) Pratapgad Fort
(IV) Bailadila iron ore mine
(V) Neyveli lignite field
(VI) Konark

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Fatehpur Sikri located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Chittorgarh located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Pratapgad Fort located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bailadila iron ore mine located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Neyveli lignite field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Konark located? 1

